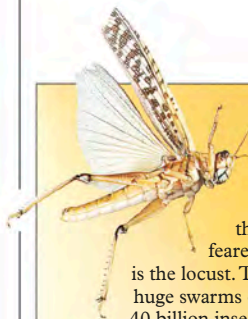


CORN



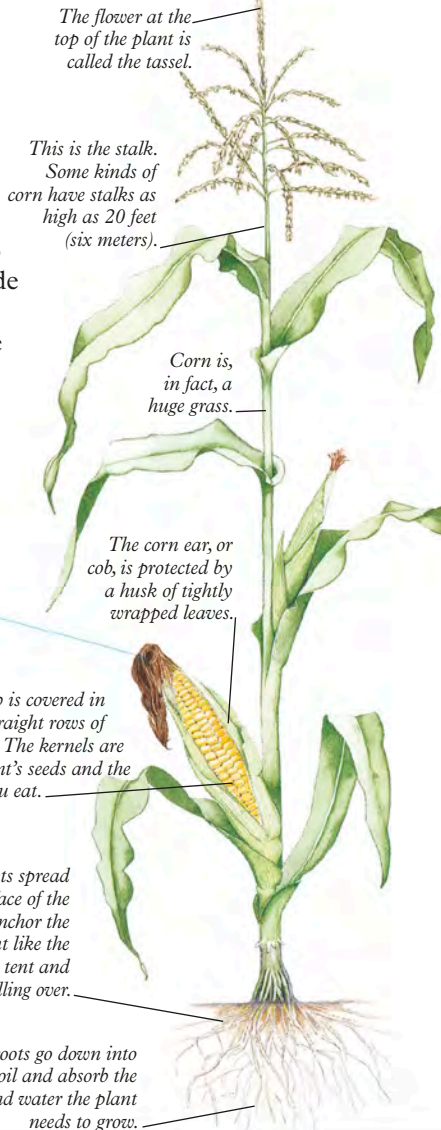
In many tropical and subtropical countries sweet corn is the main food that people eat. It is eaten as a vegetable or ground into flour or cornmeal. Corn is also made into oil for cooking and for salad dressings. Corn needs lots of sunshine to grow—it will grow in hot climates but also in cooler, mild ones, as long as there is plenty of sun. However, the varieties of corn grown in these different climates are not the same.

These long, soft threads are called the silk.



Pest problems

In warm and tropical areas, one of the pests most feared by farmers is the locust. They travel in huge swarms of more than 40 billion insects, stripping plants of their leaves and stems as they feed. Locusts can destroy crops and cause famine and starvation.



The flower at the top of the plant is called the tassel.

This is the stalk. Some kinds of corn have stalks as high as 20 feet (six meters).

Corn is, in fact, a huge grass.

The corn ear, or cob, is protected by a husk of tightly wrapped leaves.

The cob is covered in neat, straight rows of kernels. The kernels are the plant's seeds and the part you eat.

Short side roots spread over the surface of the soil. They anchor the tall plant like the ropes of a tent and stop it from falling over.

Deep roots go down into the soil and absorb the food and water the plant needs to grow.